AI Did It? The Layoff Claim Test Kit — four tools from the roiscale.ai editorial desks for flow PF-20261026-ai-did-it. *Templates and checklists, not legal advice.* Example data is labelled as such.

1. Worker & HR checklist: five checks when AI is the stated reason

By Noah Solace, Labor & Society Desk. Templates and checklists, not legal advice; check your own jurisdiction and contract.

1. **Tasks.** Which tasks moved to software, and what auto-resolution rate (share handled with no human) was measured, on which data?
2. **Exceptions.** Who now handles cases the system gets wrong or passes back, and are those people staying?
3. **Redeployment.** What retraining or internal roles are offered, with dates?
4. **US notice (WARN Act).** Generally applies to employers with 100 or more full-time workers: 60 calendar days' written notice of a covered plant closing or mass layoff, generally where 50 or more people lose their jobs at one site. Source: DOL Employer's Guide [3].
5. **UK consultation.** Proposing 20 or more redundancies at one establishment within 90 days triggers collective consultation: at least 30 days before the first dismissal for 20–99, 45 days for 100 or more, plus form HR1 to the Redundancy Payments Service. Source: GOV.UK [4].

Record for each check: the answer, who gave it, the date, and the document it came from. A blank answer is itself a finding.

2. Board payback test: five questions

By Av Ledger, Enterprise ROI Desk. Test whether the AI savings behind a cut reach the cost line, and how many months it takes to pay back.

Formula (your own calculation): payback (months) = one-off charges (severance, notice pay, restructuring) ÷ incremental annual savings × 12. Worked example from company guidance: Barclays c.£0.5bn H2 2026 charges ÷ c.£0.4bn rise in guided 2027 gross savings (>£1.1bn vs c.£0.7bn) ≈ 15 months — Av Ledger's calculation, assuming the whole uplift comes from these actions [1]. HubSpot disclosed $65m–$75m of charges and no savings figure, so no payback can be computed [2].

1. **Where is the saving booked?** Name the cost line and the quarter. Test: the run-rate saving appears in guidance, not only in the press release.
2. **What is the payback on the charge alone?** Test: charges ÷ incremental annual saving comes in under 24 months.
3. **How much is AI, and how much is something else?** Test: management splits the saving between AI, process changes and synergies. If it cannot, the AI share counts as zero.
4. **What share of the work still needs a person?** Test: a measured residual rate on held-out tasks (see tool 3), priced at the loaded cost of the people who remain.

5. **What does reversal cost?** Test: rehiring or contractor cost if the residual rate is twice the measured figure, and whether payback still holds. No sourced industry benchmark for AI-related backfill exists yet, so model your own.

3. Claim tester: how much still goes to a person?

By Rex Circuit, Builder Lab. Run the threshold sweep on your own task sample and see how much still goes to a person.

Method: TF-IDF + logistic regression (C=30) trained on Banking77 [5], CPU only. A confidence threshold is picked on the validation split; below it, the ticket goes to a person. Results below are on the 3,080-query public test split — a public benchmark, not any company's data.

Threshold	Auto-handled	Auto accuracy	Wrong, no human saw	To a person	Share to a person
0.0	3,080	91.0%	278	0	0.0%
0.3	3,004	92.4%	228	76	2.5%
0.45	2,877	94.3%	163	203	6.6%
0.6	2,689	96.5%	93	391	12.7%
0.7	2,548	97.6%	61	532	17.3%
0.85	2,235	98.6%	31	845	27.4%
0.95	1,706	99.4%	11	1,374	44.6%

Read it this way: with no gate, 278 of 3,080 customers get a wrong answer no person sees. At 0.45, 203 (6.6%) go to a person; at 0.85 (98.6% accuracy), 845 (27.4%) do. The full 20-row sweep is in the attached CSV; the script `sweep.py` (Python, scikit-learn) is available on request from the Builder Lab.

Five questions to ask when "AI did it":

1. What auto-resolution rate did you measure, and at what accuracy?
2. On which tasks? One intent sorter is not a whole job.
3. Was it measured on held-out cases the model never saw?
4. Who reviews the wrong auto answers, and how many per week?
5. How big is the exception queue after the cut, and who owns it?

4. "Who does this now" map

By Zara Nova, Builder Desk. Fill this in before you announce anything about AI and your team; one row per task the AI touches.

Task (plain words)	Who did it before (role, name)	Who does it now (agent, person, or both)	Who catches it when the agent is wrong (named person, response time)

- If column four is empty, you're not ready to announce.
- If column four is one overloaded person, announce help for that person, not savings.
- Write your post from this table, not from the demo.

Try this week: pick the task your AI touches most. Write down, by name, who catches its mistakes today and how many they caught last week.

Sources

1. Barclays, Q3 2026 Results Presentation, Oct 22, 2026. Link
2. HubSpot Inc., Form 8-K, Item 2.05, Oct 6, 2026, SEC EDGAR. Link
3. U.S. Department of Labor, Employer's Guide to Advance Notice of Closings and Layoffs (accessed Oct 27, 2026). Link
4. GOV.UK, Making staff redundant: redundancy consultations (accessed Oct 27, 2026). Link
5. Banking77 dataset (PolyAI, public bank customer-service intents), test split of 3,080 queries. Link

Technology is only progress if it moves people forward.